

SEDAR 680A Gulf of Mexico Scamp

Recommendations for considerations of future research are provided below and do not indicate any particular order of priority.

Age and Growth

Investigate methods to better collect age structure samples randomly and systematically from all fishing sectors, especially the recreational sector

Continue collaboration with ageing facilities throughout the Gulf of Mexico and South Atlantic. These efforts will include the annual reading of reference sets for Scamp and other reef fish, and annual meetings to review the interpretation of ageing structures and the timing of annual band deposition.

Natural Mortality

Explore more direct approaches to estimating natural mortality (e.g., Mark-recapture approaches (conventional, telemetry, or close-kin))

Reproduction

Continue data collection for maturity, sex transition, and fecundity as detailed in the SEDAR 68 Research Track Assessment DW Report Recommendations

Discard Mortality

Continue data collection from observer programs or electronic monitoring programs (e.g., SEDAR68-DW-22)

Develop discard mortality rates for recreational fishery by mode

Landings

Explore approaches for assigning uncertainty estimates to commercial landings and revisit estimation of historic landings

Discards

Explore approaches for assigning uncertainty estimates to recreational headboat discards

CPUE indices

Additional research is needed to investigate if assumptions are appropriate across full time series for recreational CPUE indices (e.g., targeting, trip length, effects of various regulations, Red Snapper)

Re-evaluate the appropriateness of the RFOP Vertical Line Survey for tracking trends in population abundance over time

Age and length composition

Quantify and evaluate appropriate modeling and weighting procedures of length and age compositions to ensure age and length composition inputs are representative of the segment of the population being modeled

Obtain consistent funding source to ensure continuation of sampling of discard length composition for Scamp and other reef fish

Selectivity and catchability

Further investigate and quantify changes in selectivity/catchability through time to improve fit to the discards and length compositions

Surveys

Determine how best to continue the Combined Video Survey index given changes in survey design and sampling over time